PRACTICE EXAM 4 OF 4 · FOUNDATIONS - ALL DOMAINS

Practice exam 4

The final twenty questions, then a guide to reading your results across all four practice exams, and a close to the course.

QUESTIONS 20 PEOPLE 6 PROCESS 8 BUS ENV 6

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> At the end of the design phase of a predictive project, updated market research shows the expected benefits have fallen by half. At that level, the business case no longer meets the organisation's investment threshold.
>
> The phase gate review is next week.

What should the project manager do?

A Leave the market research out of the gate pack, since design is complete.

B Stop the project immediately.

C Present the updated business case at the gate with options, including stopping or re-scoping, for governance to decide.

D Proceed to build, and review the benefits after launch.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Omit the research.
Hides decisive information from the people deciding.

B Stop now.
Not the PM's decision; that is what the gate is for.

C Updated case and options at the gate.
Gives governance the evidence and choices it needs.

D Build, review later.
Spends the build budget on a case that no longer holds.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. A gate is a decision point. Bring the updated case, honestly, with options.

> A senior developer's code review comments are technically correct but blunt and dismissive. Two junior developers have become reluctant to submit their code for review.
>
> The senior developer seems unaware of the effect.

What should the project leader do?

A. Give the senior developer private, specific feedback on the effect of the comments, and agree constructive review norms with the team.

B. Remove the senior developer from code reviews.

C. Tell the junior developers to be less sensitive.

D. Stop requiring code reviews for junior developers.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project leader do?

A Private feedback; review norms.

Addresses the behaviour and its impact, and sets shared standards.

B Remove him from reviews.

Loses his expertise, and he never learns why.

C Juniors toughen up.

Dismisses a real effect on quality and safety.

D Drop reviews for juniors.

Removes a quality control from the people who need it most.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Specific, private feedback on impact; then team norms. Keep the expertise, fix the delivery.

> A predictive project manager learns that a key supplier closes for two weeks every August. The schedule shows the supplier delivering critical components during those weeks.
>
> It is now April.

What should the project manager do?

A Ask the supplier to stay open in August for this project.

B Wait until July to see whether the supplier's plans change.

C Find a new supplier immediately.

D Update the resource calendar, re-sequence or move the deliveries, and communicate the revised plan.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Ask them to stay open.
Unlikely, and the calendar is a known constraint.

B Wait until July.
Loses months of room to re-plan.

C New supplier.
Drastic for a predictable, plannable closure.

D Update the calendar; re-sequence; communicate.
Plans around a known constraint while there is time.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. A known availability gap belongs in the resource calendar, and the schedule is planned around it.

> Sprint planning sessions on an agile team now take six hours, because most stories arrive unclear and the team spends the time working out what they mean.
>
> The team is frustrated.

What should the scrum master do?

A Shorten sprint planning to two hours, regardless of clarity.

B Help the product owner and team hold regular backlog refinement, so stories are ready before planning.

C Ask the product owner to write every story in full detail alone.

D Skip sprint planning and let developers pick stories as they go.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Cut the time only.
Unclear stories still enter the sprint.

B Regular backlog refinement.
Stories arrive ready, so planning is quick.

C PO writes everything alone.
Loses the shared understanding refinement builds.

D Skip planning.
No sprint goal, no plan.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Long planning means unready stories. Refine the backlog together, before planning.

A hybrid project's product owner asks the team to add a feature that records customers' precise locations. No privacy impact assessment has been done for it.

The organisation's data policy requires one for new personal data.

What should the project manager do?

A Arrange the privacy impact assessment with the data protection officer before the feature is built.

B Build the feature, and assess privacy before release.

C Refuse the feature, since location data is sensitive.

D Leave the decision to the development team.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Assessment before building.
Privacy by design: the policy's requirement, applied early.

B Build, then assess.
Risks building something that must be redesigned.

C Refuse it.
The feature may be fine with the right safeguards.

D Team decides.
A policy requirement is not a team preference.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. New personal data: assess privacy first. Compliance is designed in, not added.

A hybrid project needs advice from a security architect in another division. She has no obligation to help, and her own work is busy.

The project manager has no authority over her.

What is the best approach?

A Ask the sponsor to order her to help.

B Proceed without security advice.

C Meet her, explain the project and what is in it for her division, ask for a small, specific amount of help, and involve her manager if needed.

D Copy her manager on every request to create pressure.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best approach?

A Sponsor orders her.

Forces compliance, and strains a relationship you will need again.

B Go without advice.

Takes on security risk for no reason.

C Relationship, mutual benefit, specific ask.

Influence without authority, done well.

D Pressure via her manager.

Damages trust before any real conversation.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Influence without authority: build the relationship, show mutual benefit, make a small, clear ask.

A predictive project team is split between building a document management system in-house and buying a software-as-a-service product. The debate is based on opinions.

The sponsor wants a recommendation.

What should the project manager do?

A Choose the in-house option, since the team prefers it.

B Carry out a make-or-buy analysis covering total cost, capability, risk, time and strategic fit, and recommend from it.

C Choose the cheapest upfront option.

D Ask the software vendor for its recommendation.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Team preference.
Opinion, not analysis.

B Make-or-buy analysis.
Replaces opinion with evidence across the factors that matter.

C Cheapest upfront.
Ignores running costs, risk and fit.

D Ask the vendor.
A seller is not a neutral adviser.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Build or buy is decided by make-or-buy analysis, not preference or upfront price.

> A fully remote agile team member has become quiet. She keeps her camera off, contributes little in meetings, and recently said she feels 'out of the loop'.
>
> Her work quality is still good.

What should the scrum master do?

A Require all team members to keep cameras on.

B Leave her alone, since her work is good.

C Raise her low participation in the retrospective.

D Check in with her one to one, and increase connection, such as virtual pairing and informal team time.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Cameras mandatory.
A rule, not a remedy for isolation.

B Leave her.
She has said she feels out of the loop; that will grow.

C Raise it in the retrospective.
Puts a personal concern on public display.

D One-to-one; build connection.
Understands her, and reduces isolation in practical ways.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Remote isolation is solved with connection: one-to-ones, pairing and informal time.

> A national transport strike is announced for next month. A predictive project depends on deliveries of heavy equipment by road during that period.
>
> The strike could last one to three weeks.

What should the project manager do?

A Assume the strike will be called off.

B Postpone the whole project until after the strike.

C Assess the impact, update the risk register, and plan responses such as earlier delivery or alternative transport.

D Ask the supplier to absorb any delay.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Assume it is called off.
Hope is not a response.

B Postpone everything.
Disproportionate for a one-to-three-week risk.

C Assess; update risks; plan responses.
A proportionate response to a known external threat.

D Supplier absorbs it.
Shifts blame, but the equipment still does not arrive.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. A known external disruption: assess, register, and plan responses early.

> Stakeholders ask an agile team for a twelve-month roadmap showing exactly which features will ship on which dates. The team works in two-week sprints and expects priorities to change.
>
> The stakeholders need to plan marketing and training.

What should the project leader provide?

A. A roadmap with near-term detail and later themes, showing date ranges, updated at each review.

B. A fixed, feature-by-date plan for all twelve months.

C. No roadmap, since agile teams do not plan that far ahead.

D. Only the next sprint's plan.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project leader provide?

A Detailed near, themed far, with ranges.

Useful for planning, honest about uncertainty, kept current.

B Fixed twelve-month plan.

False precision that will be wrong within weeks.

C No roadmap.

Agile teams do roadmap; stakeholders have real planning needs.

D Next sprint only.

Too short for marketing and training plans.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Agile roadmaps: detail near, themes far, ranges not promises, updated often.

> A predictive data migration project has a team spending weeks correcting old records by hand. The work is repetitive, and morale and accuracy are falling.
>
> The deadline cannot move.

What should the project manager do?

A Offer overtime pay to keep people going.

B Explain why the work matters, rotate tasks, automate repetitive checks where possible, and recognise progress.

C Replace the team with contractors.

D Monitor each person's error rate and report it weekly.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Overtime pay.
More hours of tedium; accuracy falls further.

B Purpose, variety, automation, recognition.
Tackles both motivation and the repetitive work itself.

C Replace the team.
Loses knowledge, and the work stays just as tedious.

D Individual error reports.
Surveillance lowers morale further.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Repetitive work: give purpose, variety and recognition, and automate what you can.

> In a hybrid project, the team discovers problems but reports them only when they can no longer be hidden. Team members say the organisation punishes people who bring bad news.
>
> The project manager is new to the organisation.

What should the project manager do?

A Report the team's behaviour to the sponsor.

B Introduce penalties for hiding problems.

C Accept this as the organisation's culture.

D Make it safe to raise problems within the team, report honestly upwards, and work with the sponsor on how bad news is received.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Report the team.
Confirms their fear of punishment.

B Penalties for hiding.
More fear, which drives problems further underground.

C Accept it.
Late bad news will keep hurting the project.

D Safety within; honesty upwards; work with sponsor.
Changes what the PM can, and influences what they cannot.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. Assess the culture; build safety where you can, and influence the rest honestly.

A supplier offers a predictive project a 10 percent discount on materials if the order is placed two months early. The site has secure storage, and cash flow allows early payment.

The discount would save more than the storage costs.

What should the project manager do?

A Decline, since the order is not due for two months.

B Place the order immediately without checking anything else.

C Confirm the materials' specification is stable and any storage risks are covered, then take the opportunity with the necessary approval.

D Ask the supplier for a 20 percent discount instead.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Decline.
Ignores a real saving for no reason.

B Order unchecked.
Risks buying materials whose specification may still change.

C Check specification and storage; take it.
Exploits an opportunity after a quick check of its risks.

D Push for 20 percent.
May lose a good offer on a gamble.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Opportunities are managed like risks: check them quickly, then act to capture the value.

> A hybrid project must choose a new collaboration tool that the team will use every day. Team members ask to have a say in the choice.
>
> The budget and security requirements are fixed.

What should the project manager do?

A. Involve the team in setting evaluation criteria and testing shortlisted tools, within the fixed budget and security requirements.

B. Choose the tool personally to save time.

C. Let the team choose any tool it likes.

D. Ask the IT department to choose without consulting the team.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Involve the team within constraints.
Empowers the users, while keeping fixed requirements fixed.

B PM chooses.
Quick, but the daily users have no say.

C Any tool.
Ignores the fixed budget and security requirements.

D IT chooses alone.
Excludes the people who will use it all day.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Empower within boundaries: involve users in the choice, inside fixed constraints.

> A supplier on a predictive project claims an extra $80,000 for work it says was outside the contract's scope. The project manager believes the work was included.
>
> The contract has a dispute resolution clause requiring negotiation, then mediation.

What should the project manager do?

A Pay the claim to avoid a dispute.

B Review the contract and records with procurement, negotiate, and follow the dispute resolution clause if needed.

C Start legal action immediately.

D Withhold all payments to the supplier until it drops the claim.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Pay it.
Pays for work that may already be included.

B Review, negotiate, follow the clause.
Evidence first, then the contract's own route.

C Sue now.
Skips the negotiation and mediation the contract requires.

D Withhold everything.
May breach the contract on undisputed payments.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. Claims are settled from the evidence, by the contract's dispute route, in order.

> An agile team integrates everyone's code only at the end of each sprint. Each time, two or three days are lost resolving conflicts and broken builds.
>
> The sprint review is often rushed as a result.

What should the team change?

A Lengthen sprints to allow more integration time.

B Appoint one person to handle all integration.

C Integrate once a week instead of once a sprint.

D Adopt continuous integration, merging and testing small changes many times a day.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team change?

A Longer sprints.
Bigger batches, bigger integration pain.

B One integrator.
A bottleneck, and still big-batch merging.

C Weekly integration.
Better, but still batching the problem.

D Continuous integration.
Small, frequent merges make conflicts small and early.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Integration pain grows with batch size. Integrate continuously.

> A predictive project has a detailed, approved scope and a complete work breakdown structure. The sponsor needs the most accurate possible cost estimate to secure funding.
>
> The team has time to prepare it.

Which estimating approach should the project manager use?

A Analogous estimating from a similar past project.

B An order-of-magnitude estimate.

C Bottom-up estimating from the work packages, rolled up.

D Ask the sponsor what figure the funding committee expects.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which estimating approach should the project manager use?

A Analogous.
Quick, but less accurate; suits early stages.

B Order of magnitude.
The least accurate kind, for very early decisions.

C Bottom-up from work packages.
The most accurate when a full WBS exists and time allows.

D Ask what they expect.
Anchoring, not estimating.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Full WBS, time available, accuracy needed: bottom-up estimating.

> A portfolio board cuts a hybrid project's remaining funding by 20 percent to fund a higher-priority initiative. The end date is unchanged.
>
> The sponsor asks the project manager to respond.

What should the project manager do?

A. Work with the sponsor and product owner to prioritise the highest-value scope within the new budget, and update the baselines through change control.

B. Keep the full scope and hope to deliver it for less.

C. Appeal to the portfolio board to reverse its decision.

D. Cut 20 percent from every workstream equally.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Prioritise by value; rebaseline properly.
Keeps the most value within the new constraint, formally.

B Same scope, less money.
Hope, not a plan; quality or schedule will suffer.

C Appeal.
The board has made a portfolio decision for strategic reasons.

D Equal cuts.
Treats high- and low-value work the same.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. A portfolio decision changes the constraint. Re-prioritise by value; rebaseline formally.

> On a hybrid project, an offshore team always agrees to proposed deadlines in meetings, but often misses them. A team lead explains that in their culture, saying 'no' to a manager is considered disrespectful.
>
> The project manager wants reliable commitments.

What should the project manager do?

A Insist that team members say 'no' directly when a deadline is unrealistic.

B Create safer ways to raise concerns, such as asking open questions, private check-ins and team-owned estimates.

C Add a buffer to every deadline the offshore team agrees.

D Escalate the missed deadlines to the offshore team's management.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Insist on direct 'no'.
Asks people to act against their culture; unlikely to work.

B Safer ways to raise concerns.
Adapts to the culture so real information surfaces.

C Hidden buffers.
Plans around the problem instead of fixing communication.

D Escalate.
Treats a cultural difference as poor performance.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Cultural awareness: change how you ask, so the truth can be told comfortably.

> Two days after a hybrid project's release, customers report a defect that stops some payments. The fix is small, and the organisation has an emergency change process.
>
> The team wants to fix it quickly.

What should the project manager do?

A Wait for the next planned release to include the fix.

B Let a developer fix it directly in production, without recording it.

C Roll back the entire release.

D Fix it through the emergency change process, then find the root cause and prevent recurrence.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Wait.
Customers cannot pay in the meantime.

B Unrecorded fix.
Uncontrolled change in production; no record, no review.

C Roll back everything.
Disproportionate for a small, fixable defect.

D Emergency change; then root cause.
Fast and controlled, then prevention.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Urgent production fixes use the emergency change route, then root cause analysis.

Scoring guide

DOMAIN	QUESTIONS	YOUR SCORE
People	2, 6, 8, 11, 14, 19	out of 6
Process	3, 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 17, 20	out of 8
Business Environment	1, 5, 9, 12, 15, 18	out of 6
Total	20 questions	out of 20

ON THE EXAM

Across all four exams: People 26 questions, Process 33, Business Environment 21. Add up each domain.

Reading your trend across four exams

IF YOUR RESULTS SHOW	THEN
Scores rising from exam 1 to 4	The method is working. Keep practising; book your exam
One domain low in three or four exams	Rewatch that domain: 06-16, 17-30, or 31-40
The same distractor pattern, repeatedly	Rewatch modules 02 and 44; name the pattern every time
Misses on the paired questions	Slow down on the deciding detail; rewatch module 42
Flat, middling scores	Re-read missed walkthroughs; retake that exam in a week

ON THE EXAM

Where your misses cluster, and the pattern they share, matters more than the total.

Before your exam

- Aim for consistent results across **all three domains**, not one high score. PMI publishes no pass mark.
- Practise with a **full-length timed exam** from a 2026-aligned source at least once.
- Re-read **PMI's exam handbook** in the final week, and check your ID and appointment details.
- On the day: find the decision, read the qualifier, name the distractor, climb the ladder.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Consistency across domains, a full-length rehearsal, and the handbook in the final week.

Understand, assess, collaborate, act, escalate. **Lead the people. Deliver the value.**